ZORK III

THE DUNGEON MASTER

A maximum-score route to the successor ending

SCORE	MOVES	DEATHS	INSTRUCTIONS
7 / 7	282	0	210,414

Verified story: Z-machine V3, Release 17, Serial 840727. The route reaches the Treasury of Zork and the successor ending with the full 7/7 potential score and no deaths. It was replayed from a fresh game using deterministic seed 3.

How to use this guide

Follow the numbered stages in order. Commands are shown in Courier. Directions assume you are in the room reached by the previous command. When a timed or randomized event is described, follow the response text and repeat the stated action only as directed. The included regression route records the exact deterministic run.

Route checkpoints

The replay consumes 249 player commands and 210,414 VM instructions. The score reaches 7/7 before the final trial; entering the Treasury completes the story. The route uses the lake table, Shadow Land combat, the Cliff trust test, the time machine, the Royal Puzzle, and the final invisibility passage.

Story fingerprint: SHA-256 62CED461C650265EA55B17E7F0E368724E0B43BF92AF6F1A3D566E82C7608BE2

Regression route fingerprint: SHA-256 88BEB8240A6472424EF1B9C07241B11242A63D767206E5A412D3C9085F3B61D2

The opcode inventory uses 1-based instruction execution sequence numbers and hexadecimal byte addresses.

01. The Scenic Vista and the lake

Keep the torch out of the lake. The Scenic Vista table cycles through destinations; take the repellent from Room 8 at indicator II, then use the III destination to reach the Damp Passage and recover the torch later.

Get the torch and visit Room 8

```
take lantern
turn on lantern
south (four times)
enter lake
west
south
take torch
look at table
wait until the indicator reaches II
touch table
get can
z
```

Return to Scenic Vista and visit Damp Passage

```
z
wait until the indicator reaches III
touch table
drop torch
z
north
enter lake
down
take can and object
up
south
```

> The underwater pickup is time-sensitive. In this replay, the can and amulet are taken together on the first attempt. If either slips away, repeat the pickup only while you can still surface safely.

02. The key, torch, and Shadow Land

Spray yourself before entering the dark southern passage. The route reaches the Key Room while the repellent is effective, then returns through the lit Aqueduct to collect the torch. In Shadow Land, spare the hooded figure after it is defenseless.

Find the key and torch

```
spray grue repellent on self
south (twice)
east
drop can
get key
open cover
down
north (three times)
get torch
west
west
southwest
```

Defeat the figure without killing it

```
attack figure with sword (repeat until badly hurt and defenseless)
get hood
get cloak
```

Leave Shadow Land and reach the Cliff

```
east (twice)
north
west
west
get bread
down
```

> Do not attack again once the figure is badly hurt and defenseless. Taking the hood at that point reveals the Dungeon Master; the cloak remains behind.

03. The Cliff test and the sailor

The chest cannot be opened. Tie it to the rope and wait for the adventurer. When he calls down and drops the rope within reach, grab it; if the first grab only triggers his return, grab again. The earthquake begins during this sequence.

Earn the staff through trust

```
tie chest to rope
wait for the adventurer to lift the chest
wait until he returns and drops the rope
grab rope (if he only calls down, grab rope again)
down (twice)
south
```

Get the vial from the passing sailor

```
wait until the boat is alongside the shore
say "hello sailor"
get vial
north
northeast
southeast
```

Reach the Royal Museum

```
east
south
east (twice)
south (twice)
east
north
push gold machine south
open stone door
push machine east
```

04. Recover the ring and the other items

Travel to 776, take only the golden ring, and wait for the guards to leave. The door may close again while they are present. Hide the ring under the machine seat before returning to 948; looking under the seat in the present recovers it.

Take the ring in 776

```
turn dial to 776
enter machine
push button
get ring
wait until the guards have left
open door (if officials are visible, wait and try again)
west
open wooden door
north
```

Return to 948 with the ring

```
put ring under seat
turn dial to 948
enter gold machine
push button
get out
look under seat
```

Collect the remaining equipment

```
open door
south
open stone door
east
get all
west
south
down
```

05. Solve the Royal Puzzle

The Royal Puzzle is exact: one wrong wall push can make the ladder unreachable. Follow the numbered movement groups without exploring or improvising.

1. Book and first walls

```
push south wall
east
south
east (twice)
push south wall
get book
push south wall
```

2. Reach the east wall

```
push west wall (twice)
east
south
push east wall
```

3. Route to the marble wall

```
north (five times)
push east wall
west
south (four times)
east (twice)
north (three times)
push west wall
```

4. Move the ladder toward the opening

```
east
south (three times)
west (four times)
north (three times)
west
north
push east wall (three times)
```

5. Cross the lower rooms

```
west (twice)
south (twice)
east (twice)
south
push east wall
west (three times)
north (three times)
east (twice)
```

6. Align the ladder and exit

```
push south wall (twice)
west
south (twice)
east (twice)
north
push west wall (twice)
south
west
push north wall (three times)
west
north
up
```

06. Pass the tests and reach the Parapet

After exiting the puzzle, return through the Great Door to the Junction and visit the Engravings Room. If the old man is absent, go southwest to the Damp Passage and return northeast until he appears. Wake him and give him the bread to expose the secret door.

Find the old man

```
north
west
north (twice)
west (twice)
north
east
northeast
southwest to Damp Passage and northeast to Engravings Room (repeat until the old man
  appears)
wake man
give bread to man
```

Open the mirror passage

```
open door
north
north
put sword in beam
south
push button
north (three times)
raise short pole
push white panel (twice)
push pine panel
north
```

Become invisible and meet the Dungeon Master

```
open vial
drink liquid
north (three times)
knock on door
```

Reach the Parapet

```
north
west
north (twice)
turn dial to 4
push button
south
open door
south
```

07. Complete the final trial

Once inside the prison cell, the Dungeon Master remains outside. Direct him to the Parapet and have him change the dial before unlocking the bronze door.

Take the Treasury route

```
dungeon master, go to parapet
dungeon master, turn dial to 1
dungeon master, push button
unlock bronze door with key
open bronze door
south
```

Executed opcode inventory

61 unique opcodes were observed across 210,414 instructions in the fresh-game route. Counts include all story calls and output. Opcode values are hexadecimal; form disambiguates encodings. PCs are byte addresses.

Form	Opcode	Mnemonic	Count	First seq.	First PC
Variable	0x00	call	13,317	1	0x004937
Long	0x14	add	9,674	3	0x0048A5
Long	0x01	je	23,991	5	0x0048AD
Long	0x15	sub	3,132	6	0x0048B1
Short	0x00	jz	37,192	7	0x0048B5
Variable	0x01	storew	5,822	9	0x0048C0
Short	0x0B	ret	1,857	10	0x0048C5
Long	0x0D	store	13,579	13	0x00493F
Long	0x16	mul	664	14	0x004942
Variable	0x07	random	81	29	0x00497D
Long	0x0F	loadw	17,768	36	0x0048C7
Short	0x0C	jump	16,978	39	0x0048D5
Long	0x0A	test_attr	4,987	74	0x0049A5
Short	0x02	print	2,008	75	0x0049AA
Short	0x0B	new_line	875	76	0x004B11
Variable	0x09	and	80	81	0x006658
Variable	0x06	print_num	13	82	0x00665E
Long	0x05	inc_chk	5,731	84	0x006670
Long	0x10	loadb	4,743	85	0x006677
Variable	0x05	print_char	6	86	0x00667B
Short	0x00	rtrue	1,716	111	0x006682
Long	0x0E	insert_obj	174	113	0x004B19
Variable	0x08	push	1,520	118	0x00623E
Variable	0x09	pull	334	120	0x006247
Long	0x0B	set_attr	170	123	0x0062BF
Long	0x06	jin	450	125	0x0062C5
Short	0x0A	print_obj	203	126	0x0062C9
Short	0x03	get_parent	2,230	129	0x0062D2
Long	0x11	get_prop	1,874	132	0x0062ED
Short	0x0D	print_paddr	73	138	0x006303
Short	0x02	get_child	2,710	145	0x00632A
Variable	0x01	je	7,180	158	0x00641B
Short	0x01	rfalse	1,678	173	0x007A2B
Short	0x01	get_sibling	2,443	175	0x006473
Short	0x08	ret_popped	1,891	205	0x006346

Form	Opcode	Mnemonic	Count	First seq.	First PC
Variable	0x04	sread	249	260	0x004E18
Long	0x04	dec_chk	1,008	267	0x004E3E
Long	0x07	test	2,548	276	0x00507D
Long	0x03	jg	3,461	281	0x005081
Long	0x09	and	896	282	0x005085
Variable	0x02	storeb	227	295	0x004F4D
Long	0x02	jl	3,767	318	0x005509
Short	0x05	inc	838	554	0x004FF8
Variable	0x0D	store	156	768	0x005AFE
Long	0x12	get_prop_addr	3,957	778	0x005DE3
Short	0x04	get_prop_len	2,398	784	0x006062
Long	0x17	div	1,289	785	0x006065
Short	0x03	print_ret	79	961	0x006D2C
Short	0x09	remove_obj	14	14,247	0x00FFC5
Long	0x0C	clear_attr	102	14,251	0x00FFD0
Short	0x0E	load	7	20,518	0x006BB2
Long	0x13	get_next_prop	1,123	23,847	0x00E373
Short	0x06	dec	6	25,185	0x00E501
Variable	0x03	jg	17	59,014	0x005293
Variable	0x02	jl	6	63,577	0x00CE63
Short	0x07	print_addr	1	77,884	0x005875
Long	0x18	mod	880	87,049	0x008BE7
Long	0x08	or	79	87,093	0x008F13
Variable	0x14	add	158	87,180	0x0091D3
Variable	0x18	mod	3	184,901	0x00A81B
Short	0x0A	quit	1	210,414	0x00658E

Replay completion: Halted; 249 player commands; 2 MORE prompts acknowledged; final state SHA-256 C79D297FF70D360F5A1379C006763642A0DB9C9E09C986B0B57DCF57796777D5. The complete deterministic route and machine-readable instruction trace are stored under .agent/regression-routes/ locally and are intentionally ignored by Git.